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KPSC KAS (GAZETTED PROBATIONERS) EXAMINATION SYLLABUS

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1. PRELIMINARY EXAMINATION (OBJECTIVE TYPE)

PAPER I

- General Studies related to National and International Importance
- Humanities:
 - Indian Constitution
 - History of India and Karnataka
 - Geography of India and Karnataka
 - Economy

PAPER II

- General Studies related to State Importance
- General Science & Technology
- Environment & Ecology
- General Mental Ability:
 - Comprehension
 - Logical Reasoning and Analytical Ability
 - Decision Making & Problem Solving
 - Basic Numeracy
 - Data Interpretation

2. MAIN EXAMINATION (DESCRIPTIVE TYPE)

QUALIFYING PAPERS (150 Marks Each)

- Kannada & English:
 - Comprehension
 - Précis Writing
 - Communication Skills
 - Vocabulary
 - Essay

PAPER I: ESSAY (250 Marks - 3 Hours)

- Essay 1: Topics of International / National Importance (125 Marks)
 - Essay 2: Topics of State Importance / Local Importance (125 Marks)
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PAPER II: GENERAL STUDIES 1 (250 Marks - 3 Hours)

Section 1: History and Cultural Heritage (India & Karnataka)

- Unit 1: Cultural Heritage of India (Indus & Vedic Civilizations, Ancient Sanskrit literature, Science & Tech, Art/Architecture, Indian cultural contributions abroad, World Religions & Sects)
- Unit 2: Toward Transforming Indian Society: Major Schools of Thought (Modern Indian History, Reforms & Reformers, Eradication of social wrongs, Dalit movement, Hindutva, Dravida movement, Socialist approach, Gram Swaraj, Bhoodan)
- Unit 3: From Kadambaras to the Hoysalas (Kannada language/literature, ASI work, World Heritage sites, Architecture, sculpture, religion)
- Unit 4: The Vijayanagara Empire and Thereafter (1336–1799) (Origin, Administration, Battle of Talikote; Religious sects like Veerashaivism, Vachana and Haridasa movements; Bahmani/Adil Shahis; Nayakas; Rani Chennamma; Hyder Ali and Tipu Sultan)
- Unit 5: Modern Mysore (1799–1947) (Krishnaraja Wodeyar III, Armed rebellions against the British, Nizam's rule in Hyderabad-Karnataka, Progress of Mysore under Dewans)
- Unit 6: Freedom Movement in Karnataka and Unification (1885–1956) (Nationalism, Hyderabad-Karnataka struggle, Unification movement, Social/cultural developments, Miller Committee report, Folk arts)

Section 2: Social and Political Perspective

- 1. Post-Independent Karnataka (Political consolidation, Backward class commissions: Havanur, Venkataswamy, Chinnappa Reddy; Dalit & Farmers' movements, Land reforms, Gokak movement, Mahajan report, Nanjundappa report)
- 2. Social Change & Movements (Social structure, theories of change, directed social change, social policy)
- 3. Social Change & Modernisation (Role conflicts, changing status of women, Sanskritisation, westernisation, social evils, corruption, Naxalism)
- 4. Government and Political System (Legislature, Executive, Judiciary, party composition)
- 5. Decentralisation of Power (Union/State governance, Center-State relations, Panchayati Raj, regionalism/communalism)
- 6. Socio-Economic System (Jajmani system, market economy, trade unions, globalization's impact)
- 7. Rural Social System & Rural Development (Village community, power structures, bonded labour, land reform impact, Green Revolution)

Section 3: Indian Economy, Planning & Rural Development

- 1. Indian & Karnataka Economy post-independence (Sectoral growth, poverty, inequality)
- 2. India & International Economic Relations (Trade, foreign investment, BoP, Karnataka exports)
- 3. Development Patterns & Regional Disparities (SEZs, Regional development boards, mitigation policies)
- 4. Planning (Five-year plans, new economic policies, planning in Karnataka)
- 5. Decentralized Planning (Top-down vs bottom-up, PRIs, DPCs, State Finance Commission)
- 6. Rural Development (Agriculture, rural credit, markets, infrastructure, rural housing & healthcare in Karnataka)

- 7. Rural Development Initiatives (Poverty alleviation, PURA, SHGs, microfinance, tank rejuvenation)
- 8. Data Collection, Analysis & Interpretation (Charts, graphs, probability, permutation/combination, quantitative aptitude, reasoning)

PAPER III: GENERAL STUDIES 2 (250 Marks - 3 Hours)

Section 1: Physical Features and Natural Resources

- Geography of the World: Lithosphere, Atmosphere, Hydrosphere, Physiography of Continents, Demographics
- Geography of India: Physiography, climate, rivers, soils, minerals, major crops, Indian demography, industrial planning, regional development
- Geography of Karnataka: Physiographic divisions, rivers, agro-climatic zones, minerals, power sources, industries, GIS
- Urban Land Use Policy & Urbanisation: Demographics, town planning, slums, rural-urban fringe, regional trade

Section 2: Overview of the Indian Constitution

- Nature of the Constitution, Preamble, DPSP, Federation
- Fundamental Rights, reasonable restrictions, SC/ST & OBC reservations, Atrocities Act, commissions
- Distribution of legislative, administrative, and financial powers
- Unicameral/Bicameral legislatures, CAG, Attorney General, judicial review
- Constitutional Amendments, Basic Structure doctrine, Emergency provisions, 73rd & 74th Amendments
- Welfare mechanisms, statutory & constitutional commissions (Election Commission, UPSC/KPSC, NHRC, Finance Commission, etc.)
- Services under Union and States

Section 3: Public Administration, Management & International Relations

- Public vs. Private Administration, New Public Management, Responsive Administration
- Organizational structure, behavior, decision-making, delegation
- Functional Management (HR, Finance, Marketing), Leadership & Motivation
- Management Tools & Techniques (PERT/CPM, SWOT, PDCA Cycle, POSDCORB, quality tools)
- Administrative reforms, Ethics & Values, Good Governance, Lokpal & Lokayukta, citizen charters
- United Nations, Specialized Agencies (WHO, ILO, FAO, IMF, World Bank, WTO), regional groupings (ASEAN, SAARC, NATO, G-8, etc.), and India's foreign relations

PAPER IV: GENERAL STUDIES 3 (250 Marks - 3 Hours)

Section 1: Role and Impact of Science & Technology in Development

- S&T basics, national policies, ICT, e-governance, digital divide
- Space Technology (Global/Indian programs: INSAT, IRS, Chandrayaan, applications in agriculture/rural development)

- Energy Resources (Hydel, Thermal, Nuclear, Solar, Wind, Geothermal, Biofuels, Hydrogen & Fuel Cells)
- Disasters, Pests, and Pollution (Climate change, natural/man-made disasters, crop protection, waste disposal)
- Knowledge Society, Human Capital, HDI, S&T for rural upliftment, food processing, water harvesting

Section 2: Advancement and Modern Trends in Natural, Life, Agricultural Sciences & Health

- Natural Sciences: Plants, animals, microorganisms
- Agricultural Sciences: Productivity enhancement, organic farming, agro-processing, post-harvest tech
- Horticulture & Sericulture: Hi-tech horticulture, sericulture in India & Karnataka
- Biotechnology: Genetic engineering, stem cells, GM crops, bio-fertilizers, food quality standards
- Animal Husbandry: Livestock breeds, dairy cooperatives (AMUL, KMF), marine/inland fisheries
- Agriculture Policies: Seed/Credit policy, crop insurance (NAIS, WBCIS), WTO-AoA
- Health & Hygiene: Human organ systems, AYUSH, NRHM, communicable/vector-borne diseases, immunology & vaccines

Section 3: Environment and Ecology

- Environmental segments, Wildlife protection, Project Tiger, Red Data Book, eco-tourism
- Natural resources (forests, water, land, rainwater harvesting, rehabilitation)
- Ecosystems & Biodiversity (Hotspots, food chains, IPR)
- Pollution & Solid Waste Management (Acts & regulations, recycling)
- Global environmental challenges (Global warming, acid rain, river linking, ozone depletion, carbon credits)
- Joint Forest Management, community participation, disaster management

PAPER V: GENERAL STUDIES 4 (250 Marks - 3 Hours)

Section 1: Ethics

- Determinants and consequences of ethics, ethics in public/private relationships
- Ethical dilemmas in governance, laws, rules, regulations, and conscience
- Accountability, RTI, codes of conduct, citizen charters, anti-corruption
- Human values and lessons from great leaders, administrators, and reformers

Section 2: Integrity

- Impartiality, non-partisanship, objectivity, dedication to public service, empathy and compassion towards weaker sections

Section 3: Aptitude

- Foundational values for civil services, attitudes, emotional intelligence in administration
- Contributions of moral thinkers (India and the world)
- Case Studies on all ethical and integrity dilemmas

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